

Fair use guidelines

There are no specific actions that are allowed on a copyrighted content under fair use. There are some basic guidelines which should be followed while determining whether the content you are using comes under fair use or not. The most common of them are the following four factors:

- First thing you need to look at is why you are using the copyrighted content? Are you using it for educational and informative purposes? Or are you just using the idea or posting new content inspired from it? The most important factor is whether you are using it for a commercial or non-commercial purpose. Not all non-commercial uses come under 'fair use' but in most of the cases, it is enough.
- The type and nature of content you are copying also matters. Non-fictional content carries less responsibility compared to fictional content like TV shows and movies.
- The amount of the copyrighted work you are using is another important factor. The lesser you use, lesser the chances of your work being disputed. As a rule: use only as much as you need.
- The content you create using someone else's copyrighted work should in no way take away any value from the original work. It should not affect the market and reach of the original content in any way, neither should it 'steal' its views or sales.

If your work satisfies these conditions, then chances are you are good to go. But still this is no substitute for legal advice and if you find yourself confused then probably you shouldn't be doing it.

When can you use other people's content

Can you use a popular music track in your video? The answer isn't simple. If the song you want to use is copyrighted, which the chances are that it is, you should not use it.

Once a copyright expires, the work lies in the 'public domain' meaning it can be used by anyone without taking the permission from the artist.

There is another category of work called Royalty Free. Works protected under it, are free to use but don't lie in the public domain and you still need to take some sort of permission to use. So instead of using a copyrighted song and risking violation, look into royalty free music, of which there exists a large collection online. There are a number of ways to get this permission. Checkout incompetech.com, one of the most used sites for getting royalty free music online, and epidemicsound.com, where you need